



Leash Reactivity Reset

Reactivity Trigger Tracker



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Understanding Reactivity

Name the pattern before you change it.

Reactivity is not one single behavior. It can come from fear, frustration, excitement, pain, poor social history, or lack of coping skills.

TRAINER NOTE

Stay below threshold. Distance and safety come before performance.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Distance first

Your dog learns when they can notice and still think.

Soft leash

Create space early. Tension raises arousal.

Mark calm

Reward looking, sniffing, and disengaging.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

Reactive dogs are not giving owners a hard time. They are having a hard time.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- ☐ Fear reactivity
- ☐ Barrier frustration
- ☐ Freezing
- ☐ Why "he just wants to say hi" is not enough
- ☐ Frustrated greeting
- ☐ Overexcitement
- ☐ Barking and lunging

Supplies needed

- Notebook/paper (optional)
- Leash + harness



PRACTICE · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Log one reactive moment today: what was the trigger and how far away was it?

Label the type: fear, frustration, excitement, or barrier frustration.

Note body language 5 seconds before the reaction (stiff, stare, pull, freeze).

Write one thing your dog was trying to achieve (space, access, relief).

Choose one management change for your next walk.

4 Practice tracker

Date	Trigger	Distance	Body language	Notes
Day 1	Dog across street	40 ft	Stiff stare	Fear?



REVIEW · REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Getting too close to triggers too fast.
- Blaming the leash or triggers.
- Assuming all barking is aggression or dominance.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

World takes treats outside triggers.
Barking before you mark too close.
Signs of difficulty. Contact Fitdog if safety is a concern.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Understanding Reactivity" clearly.
- ☐ My dog stayed under threshold most of the week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog could still succeed.
- ☐ My dog notices triggers and eats at working distance.

Practice one skill from "Understanding Reactivity" three times this week. Note what to simplify.

What went well?

When did my dog struggle?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

No forced greetings or punishment. Safety and distance support progress.